

Feminine Hygiene: Preferences in Period Care, Hair Removal, and Plush Brand Analysis

Background & Objective:

- In today's evolving consumer landscape, the feminine hygiene market has become increasingly prominent, with a growing focus on personal care and wellness.
- To gain insights into consumer behavior and preferences related to feminine hygiene category, **Client Brands** is conducting a survey through the Company X Platform tool, targeting specific demographic segments to better understand their needs and choices.
- To understand this, a survey is run via Company X Platform, among the following **target group**:
 - Mix of women in the age group of 18-40 years of age
 - Residing in Tier-1 and Tier-2 cities in India
 - People who have been using Company X app for at least 1Y
 - People who have sampled at least 1 feminine hygiene product (sanitary pad/period panty/panty liner/tampon) in the last 1 month

Executive Summary:

Menstrual Care:

- 83% of people are currently using period care products, primarily sanitary pads.
- Most respondents prioritize product effectiveness, skin safety, and leak-free absorption when choosing menstrual care products.
- 33% of users stick to their current sanitary pad brand for 1 to 3 years.
- Preference for size variants is evident, as 88% have experimented with different sizes, particularly XL and XL+.

Hair Removal:

- Razors are the most preferred method for hair removal among respondents (59%), with a pain-free experience and safety being top priorities.
- 60% of respondents engage in hair removal either weekly or monthly.
- There is a clear preference for using different razors for specific body parts, emphasizing the importance of comfort and hygiene.
- Factors influencing razor choice include blade quality and pain-free experience, highlighting consumer prioritization of effective and safe products.

Sexual Wellness:

- 73% of respondents use lubricants, showing a preference for silicone-based options, and a significant proportion favor flavored varieties to enhance the experience.
- Among respondents, 47% have used pregnancy test kits, with a preference for midstream tests.
 - 42% of users encountered difficulties understanding instructions, suggesting a need for clearer guidelines and education around these products.

Plush Deep Dive:

- Plush demonstrates strong brand awareness, with 63% of users learning about it via social media. The first purchased products are sanitary pads (35%) and razors (29%).

- A high repeat purchase rate of 70% indicates strong customer satisfaction and brand loyalty, with 72% of users exclusively purchasing the same Plush product after their initial experience.
- Performance ratings for menstrual care products are generally high, particularly in softness and absorption, although odor control requires improvement.
- Interest in new products is evident, with 66% of users expressing a desire for intimate washes.

Study Findings:

SECTION 0: Familiarity and Preferences

Familiarity and Preferences in Feminine Hygiene Products:

- **High familiarity:** A substantial 98% of respondents report being familiar with feminine hygiene products, indicating strong awareness.
- **Predominant use of core products:** Period-care (83%) and hair removal products (81%) are the most commonly used product, reflecting their essential role in hygiene routines.
- **Regular grooming habits:** Nearly half of the respondents (47%) engage in personal grooming related to hygiene once a week, highlighting a routine approach to personal care.
- **Willingness to try new options:** A combined 75% of respondents either "always" (19%) or "sometimes" (56%) seek out new feminine hygiene products, suggesting a strong interest in exploring new options.

SECTION 1: MENSTRUAL CARE

Product Usage and Loyalty:

- **Product Usage:**
 - 73% of respondents primarily use sanitary pads, making them the most preferred period care product overall.
- **Brand Loyalty:**
 - 61% of users have been using their current sanitary pad brand for over 3 years.
 - 28% of users have been loyal to their brand for more than 6 years, highlighting a strong brand attachment.

Product Preferences and Buying Parameters:

- **Preference for Size Variants:**

- 88% of respondents have tried different size variants for sanitary pads, with XL (71%) and XL+ (64%) being the most popular.
 - Among Plush users, 97% have experimented with size variants, indicating a higher tendency to explore within the brand, with XL (75%) and XL+ (71%) with most tried sizes.
- **Preferred Pack Size and Price:**
 - **47%** of respondents prefer purchasing sanitary pads in packs of 30-40 pads.
 - Plush users show a higher preference, with **60%** opting for this pack size, compared to **40%** of non-plush users.
 - **40%** of overall respondents prefer a price range of **Rs 240-300** for a pack of 30 pads, while 37% prefer a price range of Less than Rs. 240
 - However, majority (54%) of Plush users prefer to spend Rs. 240-300 and 25% willing to spend Rs. 300-450 per pad.
- **Purchasing Parameters:**
 - **Quality Focus:** Product effectiveness is prioritized by consumers, with **83%** valuing skin safety, **79%** leak-free absorption, and **78%** rash-free features as "very important."
 - **Ingredient Awareness:** 71% consider being toxic-free essential parameter, highlighting growing consumer concern about product safety.
 - **Material Preference:** 59% prefer cotton-based pads, but quality remains more critical than material type.
 - **Price Sensitivity:** Only 34% rate price as "very important", indicating quality preference over price
- **Preference for Established Brands:**
 - 80% of respondents prefer established brands when purchasing sanitary products.
 - 62% of Plush users show openness to newer brands, indicating a shift toward trying alternative options.
 - Among those who tried newer brand, 80% of them reverted to their original brands
- **Discovery and Trial of Newer Brands:**
 - 59% of respondents discovered newer brands through online research, while 29% relied on social media.
 - A higher 73% of Plush users found these brands online, with no Plush users discovering them in quick commerce or physical stores.
 - 41% of respondents cited product safety and non-toxicity as the main reasons for trying newer brands.
- **Brand Switching Behavior:**

- 80% of respondents reverted to their original brands after trying newer brands, primarily due to discomfort and leakage.
- **Reasons for Switching Back:**
 - 64% of respondents switched back due to discomfort with thickness, softness, or skin irritation, and 49% faced leakage issues.
 - 73% of Plush users experienced discomfort, and a higher proportion (58%) also cited the higher cost of newer brands as a reason for switching back

SECTION 2: HAIR REMOVAL

- **Hair Removal Frequency and preferred methods:**
 - 31% of respondents remove hair weekly, while 27% do so monthly.
 - Plush users tend to remove hair more frequently, with 36% opting for weekly removal compared to 28% of others.
 - Razors are the most popular method, used by 59% of respondents, followed by Hair removal creams at 23%
 - Plush users show a slightly higher preference for razors (62%) compared to others (58%).
 - Pain-free experience (67%), Safety (54%), Hygiene (53%) & Convenience (52%) are top priorities while looking for hair removal methods.
- **Razor Usage and Frequency:**
 - The majority of respondents currently use Razor for hair removal.
 - 58% of respondents do not prefer to use the same razor across all body parts.
 - Respondents cited using a different razor for Bikini Area (59%) and Face (56%) as Very important.
- **Body Part-Specific Razor Usage & Frequency:**
 - For body razors/trimmers, 26% of respondents plan to use them once a month, while Plush users are more likely to use them twice a week (16% vs. 9% for others).
 - For face razors/trimmers, 25% of respondents plan to use them for specific occasions, with Plush users tending to use them weekly (29%).
 - For bikini razors/trimmers, 31% of respondents plan monthly usage, but Plush users prefer weekly use (26%).
- **Pack Size, Factors Influencing Razor/ Hair Removal Cream Choice:**
 - **Razors:**
 - Pack of 3 for razors is most preferred by respondents (30%), while Plush users show higher preference for larger pack size
 - 38% of respondents replace their razors every 1-2 months, while Plush users replace them more frequently (49%).
 - Blade Quality (72%) and Pain-free experience (69%) remain top factors while purchasing razors.
 - **Hair Removal Creams:**

- Safe for Skin (71%), Finish it provides to skin (63%) remains top factor for respondent while choosing hair removal creams.
- **Preferred Pack Size & Razor Replacement Frequency:**
 - 30% of respondents prefer packs of 3 razors, with 28% opting for 4 or more. Plush users show a stronger preference for larger packs (31%).
 - 38% of respondents replace their razors every 1-2 months, with Plush users replacing them more frequently (49%).
- **Brand Usage and Place of purchase:**
 - Veet (68%), Gillette Venus (64%), Sirona (61%) are the most used brands by respondents.
 - New age brands like Bombae (58%) & Sanfe (42%) have a good usage rate compared to established brands like Veet & Gillette Venus indicating preference for newer brands. (Reframe)
 - However, Plush (33%) falls behind in usage compared to Bombae & Sanfe.
 - E-commerce platforms (53%) remain a usual choice for purchasing Hair removal products.
- **New vs Established Brands:**
 - 45% of respondents prefer newer brands
 - Skin-comfort (58%) being the primary reasons behind trying newer brands.
 - Social media (46%) acts as a key platform for discovering newer brands.

SECTION 3: SEXUAL WELLNESS

Lubricants

- **Lubricant Usage, Preferred Type and Flavor:**
 - 73% of respondents use lubricants.
 - Silicone-based lubricants are preferred by 60%, followed by water-based options at 40%.
 - Plush Users prefer silicone-based lubricants (56%).
 - 71% of respondents prefer flavored lubricants, indicating a strong inclination towards enhancing sensory experience.
- **Purchasing Factors, Place of purchase and Brand Used:**
 - 76% of respondents consider skin safety as a very important factor when purchasing lubricants, followed closely by the lubricant base type (62%).
 - E-commerce platforms (54%) are the preferred channel for purchasing lubricants, citing convenience and privacy behind the same.
 - Plush Users prefer e-commerce slightly more (59%) than non-Plush users (43%), indicating a trend towards online shopping for personal care products.
 - **Brand Usage:** 88% of respondents have tried Durex, making it the most used brand, followed by Kama Sutra (71%) and Manforce (68%).

- 66% of respondents have used Plush, indicating a competitive standing in brand usage.

Pregnancy Kit:

- **Usage and Instruction:** Overall, 47% of respondents have used a pregnancy test kit, with 42% encountering difficulties in understanding instructions.
- **Preferred Test Kit Types:** 56% prefer midstream (pee-on-the-strip) tests, while 44% opt for container-based tests.

DEEP DIVE – PLUSH USERS

Plush Brand Awareness and Product Adoption

- **Awareness Sources:** 63% of Plush users learned about the brand via social media, highlighting effective presence on social media.
- **First Products Purchased:** Sanitary pads (35%) and Razor (29%) are the most popular initial purchases of consumers.
 - **50%** of consumers purchased their first products from Menstrual Care category, while 40% purchased from Hair removal category.

Purchase Behavior and Product Usage

- **Repeat Purchases:** **70%** of users re-purchased the same product, demonstrating high customer satisfaction, while 25% purchased different products from Plush.
- **Duration of Use:** **41%** of users have used Plush products for 3 to 6 months, suggesting growing brand familiarity.

Purchasing Channels and Brand Loyalty

- **Purchase Channels:** **57%** of users buy from e-commerce platforms, while 15% uses brand website.
- **Brand Exclusivity:** 72% of respondents who initially purchased a product from Plush now exclusively buy that product from Plush, citing strong brand loyalty and consumer satisfaction.

Key Purchase Factors

- **Sanitary Pads:** A rash-free guarantee influences 94% of users' decisions, underscoring the importance of skin safety.
- **Razors:** Positive reviews significantly impact 75% of users' choices when buying Plush razors.

Product Performance Ratings

- **Menstrual Care Products:** High rating indicates the consumer satisfaction for the products, however the odor control remains an area of improvement
 - **Softness of the Material: 4.4 (58% rated as Excellent)**
 - **Leak-free absorption: 4.4 (50% rated as Excellent)**
 - **Rash-free nature: 4.3 (50% rated as Excellent)**
 - **Skin Safety: 4.3 (46% rated as Excellent)**
 - **Odor Control: 3.9 (27% rated as Excellent)**

- **Hair Removal Products:** Moisturizing properties and safe for skin received low rating compared to other attributes, remains an area of improvement
 - **Effectiveness in hair removal:** 4.2 (52% rated as Excellent)
 - **Pain-free trimming experience:** 4.1 (43% rated as Excellent)
 - **Ease of use:** 4.0 (39% rated as Excellent)
 - **Moisturizing properties:** 3.9 (35% rated as Excellent)
 - **Safe for skin:** 3.8 (39% rated as Excellent)

Product Development and Future Offerings

- **Interest in New Products:** 66% of users want intimate washes, showing demand for complementary hygiene products.
- Interest in fragrances and deodorants (**55%**) suggests potential for product diversification